



Muncie Fire Merit Commission May 14, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xRhpTWKNMIE
Publication Date	2026-05-14T22:11:24Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Report: Fire Merit Commission

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to the regular meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Dale called the regular May meeting of the Fire Merit Commission to order [00:00:01](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** President Dale, Vice President Gray, Secretary Cooley, Commissioner Rose, and Commissioner Wyatt.
 - **Members Absent:** None (Ms. White was noted as absent initially for roll call purposes by President Dale, but subsequently all commissioners including Commissioner White were recorded as present [00:00:31](#)).
 - **Other Officials Present:** Fire Chief Burford and Attorney Mark Irvin.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Item: 00:02:21** Approval of the April 9th meeting minutes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote following a motion and a second.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:44 Item Identifier & Title:** Certification of the 2026 Promotions List & Prospective Change to Rule 8 (Section 89C)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Dale / Commission Body
 - **Deliberation Summary:** President Dale announced that the commission would *not* take action on certifying the 2026 promotions list or on the prospective rule change to Rule 8 (Section 89C) during this meeting. It was discovered that a required procedural distribution of the rule change to department membership for comment had not been completed by the department secretary. To ensure a clean promotion process and avoid any conflicts or the appearance of impropriety regarding contradicting rules in Section 8, the commission deferred certification until the next meeting once the rule change is formally distributed and acted upon.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this portion.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred to the next meeting (agreed upon via informal voice consensus).
 - **00:04:07 Item Identifier & Title:** Benjamin Renz Investigation Review (Judge Fike's Order)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Dale / Chief Burford
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission discussed a judicial order from Judge Fike requesting the body to determine if a proper investigation was conducted regarding Benjamin Renz. Reviewing an executive session report and documentation prepared by Chief Burford, a commissioner moved to send the investigative document along with a cover letter stating that an investigation was indeed conducted and that the commission stands by its original decision.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (5-0).
 - *Roll Call:* Secretary Cooley (Yes), Commissioner Rose (Yes), President Dale (Yes), Vice President Gray (Yes), Commissioner Wyatt (Yes).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:06:32 (Unidentified Resident / Audience Member):**
 - Inquired about the status of the 2026 promotions list certification. Commission members and leadership explained the reasoning behind deferring the certification

due to the uncompleted rule change distribution.

- **00:07:56 Christopher Bilbrey:**

- Addressed the commission regarding transparency issues on the municipal website. Noted that local agendas and minutes are severely outdated (agendas listed up to January 2025 and minutes up to January 2026). The commission acknowledged the issue, noting it is the responsibility of the board secretary to ensure documents are posted.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Chief Burford provided operational updates: the ladder climb portion for new recruits and candidate lists was successfully completed (all attending candidates passed within the 3-minute, 70-foot/70-degree parameter; 2 no-shows, 2 departures to other departments); the current recruit academy is slightly past the halfway point of the fire portion and will soon transition to EMS training; monthly certifications and recertifications were provided in the board packets.

- **Adjournment:**

- Motion to adjourn made and seconded **00:08:49**, approved by voice vote. Meeting adjourned.

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-15 02:01:06 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.